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***Artes praedicandi and artes orandi.* By Marianne G. Briscoe and Barbara H. Jaye. (Typologie des sources du Moyen Age occidental, fasc. 61, A-vi.B.4 et A-vi.D.4*.) Pp. 118. Turnhout: Brepols, 1992. 2 503 36000 9; 2 503 36061 0**

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organised than the regular orders, though often connected with them; a focus on the ubiquity, variety and social importance of spiritual initiatives among women. Geographically, the groups studied cover cities in north Italy, Tuscany and Umbria, with one on the female religious community in Rome. Writing on Umbria Mario Sensi observes that the transition from a close rural to an urban and international culture is paralleled by the replacement of the monastic ideal by that of an 'eremitismo cittadino'. Here the spiritual initiative was often taken by members of the new ruling class (pp. 57-8). On the other hand, Rusconi notes that it was often among women of humbler background that visions, prophecies, prodigies appeared (p. 22). Anna Papi sees the breakdown of old structures of solidarity in Tuscany as stimulating new forms of association such as Orders of Penitence (p. 94). Ernesto Menisto uses the apostolic process for the canonisation of Chiara da Montefalco to illuminate popular concepts of sanctity juxtaposed to the ecclesiastical (pp. 107-26). Recluses, incarcerated hermits, penitential groups of lay people appear everywhere and the concern of ecclesiastical authorities to control this religious exuberance causes tensions which are resolved in various ways, including that of the tertiary concept. Spiritual movements among women constitute the main theme of this book. The instability of the times formed a socio-political pressure leading to new types of female association, but women also engaged in the traditional activities provided by orphanages and hospitals. The great figures among the women exercised astonishingly independent authority: limited educationally, subordinated legally, excluded politically, hampered socially, they effectively used one great asset - 'il carisma religioso' (p. 245). Exercising this gift they had access through the Church to a social power otherwise denied them. Chiara Frugoni's study of mysticism and iconography (pp. 127-55) raises in the mind the question of how far it is possible to communicate the essence of mystical experience. Rusconi's essay on S. Bernardino of Siena and marriage includes an important and surprising reference to the influence of the Franciscan Petrus Joannis Olivi on Bernardino (pp. 176-8). Anna Esposito gives us a fascinating study of spirituality among noble Roman women in the fifteenth century (pp. 187-208), while Gabriella Zarri brings out a new emphasis on the role of 'prophetic' women as oracles and councillors to various Italian rulers, such as Federico da Montefeltro, the Estes of Ferrara, and the Bentivoglio of Bologna (pp. 209-36). As Bornstein says in conclusion, this is 'microstoria' which throughout keeps close to the detailed, local sources, affording us many vivid vignettes. The overall picture can rightly be left to emerge in the reader's imagination because the themes of the individual essays are so closely linked.

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Artes praedicandi and artes orandi. By Marianne G. Briscoe and Barbara H. Jaye. (Typologie des sources du Moyen Age occidental, fasc. 61, A-vi.B.4 et A-vi.D.4*.) Pp. 118. Turnhout: Brepols, 1992. 2 503 36000 9; 2 503 36061 0. This volume promises to be a bibliographical nightmare. It comprises two completely independent short works, joined only by their binding and pagination: even the title page asserts their separateness. They offer succinctly useful introductory discussions of the two types of source material, Briscoe's

survey of the *artes praedicandi* being the longer at sixty-six pages (Jaye has forty). Their overall format is similar, an initial bibliography followed by assessment of the definition and development of the genre, a discussion of the sources as such, and comments on available texts and the source's historical value (fairly briefly treated). Despite the similarities, there are differences: Briscoe ends firmly at 1500, but Jaye happily ventures into the early seventeenth century; Briscoe keeps most quotations in Latin, while Jaye renders almost everything into English. Of the two genres, the *artes praedicandi* are the easier to tackle, exemplified in a clutch of texts which give themselves the label in their titles. Briscoe highlights the crucial fourteenth-century shift as the authors moved from instructing in the preparation of sermons, which clerics would appreciate, to concern about conveying the faith to the laity. What also comes through is the lack of continuity and coherence in these texts, and the clearly regional importance of particular tracts. The reminder that there are surprisingly few of these works, and that most survive only in single manuscripts, is also important: modern accessibility through print here clearly distorts the medieval reality. The *artes orandi* pose greater problems: Jaye's task is harder, and more innovatory. The category is admittedly somewhat artificial; its definition and the identification of appropriate works is accordingly more tentative and perhaps more debatable. If the genre includes all texts which offer exhortations to prayer and brief comments on its performance, it must extend far beyond the texts treated here; but it also then threatens to dissolve as a type because such material appears in a wide variety of works. Nevertheless this is again a worthwhile introduction to the sources, and the summaries of texts bring out some striking points. Together the two pieces offer good starting points for those wishing to explore the material in greater depth.

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John le Neve, Fasti Ecclesiae Anglicanae 1541–1857, VII: Ely, Norwich, Westminster and Worcester dioceses. Compiled by Joyce M. Horn. Pp. x+142. London: University of London, Institute of Historical Research, 1992. £18.
1 871348 12 9

In a fast-changing academic world, where everything is subject to question, it is a real pleasure to greet the arrival of a new volume in the valuable and long-running series devoted to updating and amending John le Neve's original work on the higher clergy of the Church of England. Here at least can be observed the fruits of scholarship, attention to detail and painstaking labour. The latest (the seventh) volume in the project's work on the post-Reformation dioceses of England and Wales covers three cathedrals transformed by Henry VIII from monastic to secular institutions, and the fate of the cathedral (for a decade only, from 1540–50) and later collegiate church of Westminster. Each institution is dealt with from its (re-) foundation until the suspension of prebends in the 1840s and 1850s (recommended as a result of the enquiries and reports of the Ecclesiastical Commissioners in the 1830s). The tables of the chronology of the suspensions, and how occasioned, are a particularly welcome feature of this volume (as they were also of the volume covering Canterbury, Rochester and Winchester). Another helpful feature of this compendium volume is the index, which illustrates well how few prebendaries (apart from a few high fliers) had